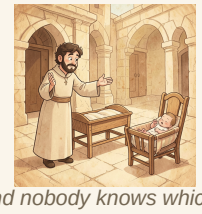
LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 48 · November 05, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Bekhorot 48 opens a run of mishnayot on safek pidyon haben: twin boys, nobody knows which is the bechor; a father who dies before his sons divide the estate; Rabbi Meir against Rabbi Yehuda over whether the property stays liened. The gemara turns on two Yosef ben Shimons, a guarantor who is only a backup, brothers who are half heirs and half buyers, and the rule of five — never half of five. Then a second mishnah: two wives, babies mixed up in a dark cave, and kohanim who won't refund.

מי שלא בכרה · THE DEAD TWIN'S ALIBI



1. A first-time mother gives birth to twin boys and nobody knows which came first — but one of them is certainly the bechor, so the father pays five selaim. Then one twin dies within thirty days, before the pidyon obligation kicks in.

“Now the father has the perfect alibi: the one who died was the bechor, and he didn't live thirty days. The one still alive? Not the bechor — and the kohen can't prove otherwise.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 48a · מי שלא בכרה — the dead twin was the bechor · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 1:42

שני יוסף בן שמעון · THE WRONG YOSEF



2. A man lends money to Yosef ben Shimon — but there are two of them in the city. He goes to the first: 'Not me, must be the other Yosef.' He goes to the second: 'Not me, must be the other Yosef.' Neither will pay.

“Then the two Yosefs buy a field together — and the creditor can collect either way: 'If my claim is against you, I'm taking your share; if it's against your friend, I'm taking his.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 48a · שני יוסף בן שמעון — 'not me, the other Yosef' · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 10:25

נכסי דבר אינש אינון ערבין ביה · THE BACKUP WHO ISN'T



3. Rabbi Yirmeya's Yosef trick has a hole, and Rava drives a cart through it: the field is only an arev, a guarantor, for the borrower. The guarantor is a backup — you go to the borrower first, and only then to him.

“Rava asks: if you can't claim from the borrower, can you claim from his guarantor? If each brother can push the kohen off, the field can't owe him either.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 48a · נכסי דבר אינש אינון ערבין ביה — the guarantor is only a backup · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 13:29

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האחין שחלקו · THE DEFINITELY-MAYBE DECREE



4. Rav Asi says brothers who divide an inheritance are half heirs and half buyers. Tosafot asks the obvious: Rav Asi himself isn't sure — it's a safek whether they're yorshim or lokchim. So why 'half and half' instead of 'the kohen must prove it'?

“Tosafot's answer: sometimes when the chachamim themselves don't know, they make a takanah — we will treat it as definitely half and half. Not 'maybe half,' but vadai half. The doubt is resolved by declaring it resolved.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 48a · האחין שחלקו — half heir, half buyer, by decree · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 21:14

חמש ולא חצי חמש · THE TWO-AND-A-HALF-SELA PROBLEM



5. The whole estate is worth exactly five selaim. Each brother gets two and a half — half as an heir, half as a buyer. An oral loan (and pidyon haben is one) can only be collected from the heir's half. So the kohen can take one and a quarter from each brother.

“One and a quarter plus one and a quarter is two and a half — and the Torah says five, not half of five. So the kohen gets nothing at all.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 48b · חמש ולא חצי חמש — one and a quarter plus one and a quarter is not five · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 29:39

שתי נשים · THE KOHANIM'S REFUND POLICY



6. Two wives give birth to two boys in a dark cave and the babies get mixed up, so the father pays ten selaim — five per bechor. One baby dies within thirty days, so one pidyon was never owed. If he paid one kohen, the kohen returns five. But if he paid two kohanim?

“He can't get a sela back. Each kohen says: 'I have the five selaim of the bechor who stayed alive.' The father can't prove which payment was for the baby who died — and המוציא מחבירו עליו הראיה means the kohanim keep it all.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 48b · שתי נשים — one kohen refunds, two kohanim keep it · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 53:11